

Reading the Face

The consultation, the conditions that change your plan, and knowing precisely where your practice ends

Learning Objectives

- Conduct a full pre-application skin and eye-area assessment
- Identify conditions that require adapting a service, and conditions that require declining one
- Explain the hygiene risks specific to eye and lip products, and how to manage them
- Recognise when a request calls for referral rather than application

The face tells you what it can safely wear

No Amber makeup service begins with product. It begins with a look, a few questions, and a willingness to adjust or decline the plan based on what you find. A confident artist is not one who always proceeds as booked — she is one who knows, precisely, when proceeding as booked would be a mistake.

The four-part pre-application assessment

1. **Visual scan.** Look for active breakouts, visible irritation, flaking, redness, or anything around the eyes suggesting infection.
2. **Verbal history.** Ask about known allergies (fragrance, latex in sponges, specific pigments), recent treatments (chemical peels, injectables, lash extensions), and skin sensitivities.
3. **Touch check.** With clean, gloved hands, gently assess texture and any tenderness before product ever makes contact.

4. **Occasion and duration.** Ask how long the makeup needs to last and under what conditions — a daytime meeting, an outdoor wedding, a photographed event — since this materially changes product choice, covered fully in Module Seven.

Conditions that call for adaptation

- **Active acne or inflammation.** Use clean, dedicated tools, avoid heavy or comedogenic formulas, and apply with a light hand rather than attempting full coverage that will emphasise texture.
- **Sensitive or reactive skin.** Patch test any new product on the inner wrist before it goes near the face, particularly for fragrance-heavy formulas.
- **Recent chemical peel or treatment.** Skin may be more permeable and reactive than usual; use gentler, fragrance-free products and check with the client on any aftercare restrictions from her treatment provider.

Conditions that call for declining the service

- **Conjunctivitis (pink eye) or any active eye infection.** No eye makeup, full stop — this is contagious and can worsen with product application.
- **Active cold sores.** No lip product from communal palettes; use single-use applicators only, and consider postponing lip application entirely if the sore is active and open.
- **Suspicious or changing moles or lesions.** Do not apply makeup directly over an area a client has not had medically assessed if it shows signs of recent change — refer, as taught in Course I, Module Three.

A Note from Practice

A bridal client arrives for her trial with a small, crusted sore at the corner of her mouth she describes as "just chapped." A closer visual check is consistent with an early cold sore rather than simple dryness. The correct response is not to apply lip colour directly over it and hope for the best on a scheduled morning.

Explain gently what you observe, recommend she see a doctor for an antiviral if it is a cold sore, and offer to proceed with the rest of the face today while leaving lips for a follow-up check closer to the date — protecting both her comfort and the health of your kit.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

1

[object Object]

2

[object Object]

Practical Activity · The Assessment Card

Perform a full four-part assessment on a partner or model, including occasion and duration questions. Record findings on a written consultation card, adjusting your planned product choices based on what you find. **File this card — your first completed makeup consultation record.**